NEWCASTLE'S INDUSTRIAL CHANGE

Resource 4 — Research Source Pack

INQUIRY QUESTION

How has industrial change in Newcastle affected the wellbeing of individuals and the broader community?

YOUR TASK

Read the four sources below. Highlight or underline evidence showing how industrial change affected:

- **Individual wellbeing:** employment, income, identity and personal security.
- **Community wellbeing:** the local economy, environment and opportunities.

Look for both positive and negative consequences. Record your findings on page 2.

SOURCE A — Workers and the BHP Closure

In September 1999, steel production ended at BHP's Newcastle steelworks in Mayfield. The closure marked the end of an important chapter in the city's industrial history.

For workers, losing a long-term job could affect more than income. Industrial employment had provided skills, routines, friendships and a sense of identity. Some workers faced uncertainty about finding another job, particularly if their experience was closely connected to steelmaking.

The closure also affected families and businesses that depended on the steelworks and its employees.

Adapted classroom summary based on ABC, *The World Today*, 30 September 1999.

View original ABC source

SOURCE B — A Changing Environment

Heavy industry provided jobs and supported Newcastle's economy, but it also created environmental concerns for nearby communities.

Residents around the Mayfield industrial area had experienced the effects of living close to large industrial operations. The end of steel production raised the possibility of a cleaner local environment.

However, environmental improvements did not remove concerns about job losses and the future of the local economy.

Different members of the community could therefore experience the same industrial change in very different ways.

Adapted classroom summary based on ABC, *The World Today*, 30 September 1999.

View original ABC source

SOURCE C — Finding Work After Steelmaking

The effects of the BHP closure continued long after 1999. Former workers had to consider what employment might look like beyond the steel industry.

Retraining and learning new skills could help workers move into different occupations. For some, this created opportunities to begin a new career or use their existing skills in another industry.

However, changing careers could also be difficult. Workers might need additional qualifications, time or financial support.

New jobs did not necessarily offer the same pay, security or sense of belonging as their previous employment.

Adapted classroom summary based on ABC, *PM*, 2013.

View original ABC source

SOURCE D — Honeysuckle's Redevelopment

While BHP's steelworks was located in Mayfield, Honeysuckle had its own industrial history involving railway workshops, goods handling and waterfront activities.

From the early 1990s, former industrial land at Honeysuckle began being transformed into a mixed-use waterfront area. Redevelopment introduced spaces for businesses, housing, hospitality and public recreation.

These changes created different employment opportunities and changed how people used the area. They also raised questions about which industries, workers and community interests would benefit most from redevelopment.

Adapted classroom summary based on HCCDC, *Honeysuckle*.

View original HCCDC source

RESEARCH NOTES

Industrial Change and Wellbeing

Name: _____ **Class:** _____

pale **Source**	**Individual wellbeing**	**Community wellbeing**
A Workers		
B Environment		
C Retraining		
D Honeysuckle		

THINK ABOUT THE EVIDENCE

1. Who benefited from Newcastle's industrial change?

Identify one group and explain how they benefited.

2. Who may have been disadvantaged?

Identify one group and explain the challenges they faced.

3. Was industrial change ultimately positive or negative for Newcastle?

Give your opinion and support it with evidence from at least one source.